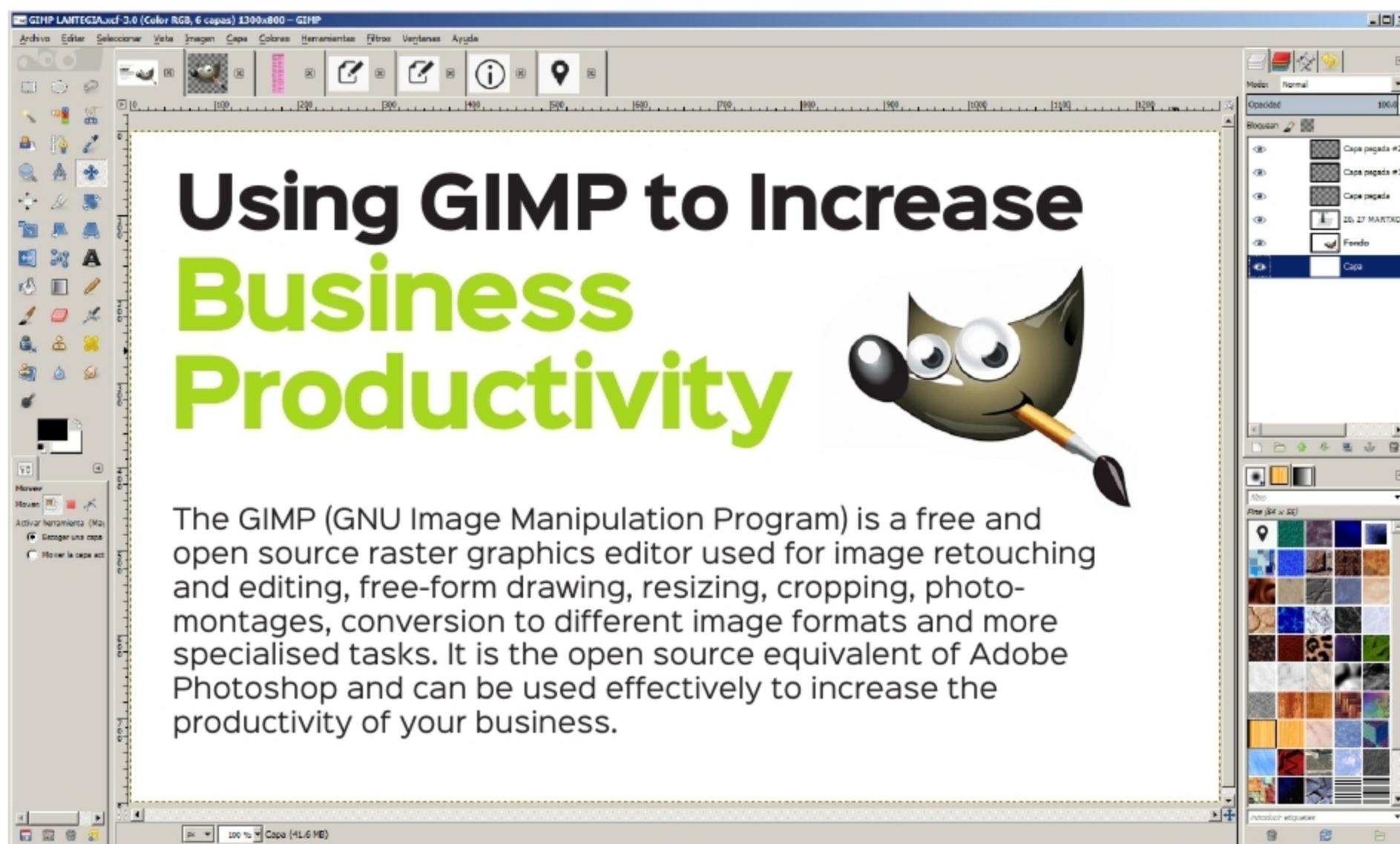




Businesses that restrict themselves to proprietary software like Microsoft Office and Adobe Photoshop get a raw deal. Not only do they have to pay for the software but they have to factor in the cost incurred every time the software becomes corrupt. This includes the fee to be paid to the computer technician to re-install the software. It should be the primary aim of every business to develop a system that automates maintenance to the maximum possible extent. This is where open source software like LibreOffice, the GIMP, Inkscape, Firefox, etc, come in.

The GIMP is primarily developed by volunteers as a free and open source software project associated with both the GNU and GNOME projects. Development takes place in a public Git source code repository, on public mailing lists and in public chat channels on the GIMPNET IRC network. New features are held in separate public source code branches and merged into the main (or development) branch when the GIMP

team is sure they won't damage existing functions. Sometimes this means that features that appear complete do not get merged or take months or years before they become available in the GIMP.

The version number used in the GIMP is expressed in a major-minor-micro format, with each number carrying a specific meaning. The first (major) number is incremented only for major developments (and is currently 2). The second (minor) number is incremented with each release of new features, with odd numbers reserved for in-progress development versions and even numbers assigned to stable releases. The third (micro) number is incremented before and after each release (resulting in even numbers for releases and odd numbers for development snapshots), with any bug fixes subsequently applied and released for a stable version. The user interface of the GIMP is created by a dedicated design and usability team. The GIMP itself is released as source code, after which, installers and packages are

made for different operating systems by developers who might not be in contact with the maintainers of the GIMP.

The current version of the GIMP works with various operating systems including Microsoft Windows, Linux and Mac OS. Many Linux distributions have the GIMP as a part of their desktop operating systems, including Fedora and Debian.

Features of the GIMP

The tools used to perform image editing can be accessed via the toolbox, through menus and dialogue windows. They include filters and brushes, as well as transformation, selection, layer and masking tools.

Colour

There are several ways of selecting colours, including palettes, colour choosers, and using an eyedropper tool to select a colour on the canvas. The built-in colour choosers include RGB/HSV selector or scales, the water-colour selector, CMYK selector and a colour-wheel selector. Colours can